# Paper Summary

**Title: Paper 1**
Generative AI for Software Project Management: Insights from a Review of a Software Practitioner Literature

**Authors, year, where published:**
Lakshana Iruni Assalaarachchi (Monash University)
Zainab Masood (Prince Sultan University)
Rasgina Hoda (Monash University)
John Grundy (Monash University)

**Year:** 2025
2025 IEEE “accepted on 7th October 2025”

**Published in:** IEEE Software, a magazine/journal

**Type of Study:**
Grey Literature Review

**Who They Studied?**
They studied that software project managers mainly use GenAI as their “assistant” or a “friend” rather than their replacement. They use GenAI for communication, collaboration, performing repetitive tasks and predictive analysis for the project’s success.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that GenAI has started to show its ability to transform the software engineering field. However, for an SPM role, it is evolving alongside GenAI and is being used to perform routine activities. Moreover, the major concern faced by the authors is how GenAI is being used by software practitioners in an SPM role and the challenges faced by them while using the AI.

**Engineer vs Manager:**
Both roles need communication and collaboration, so for that ultimately managers are needed in both of them.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper gives us the evidence of how SPM use GenAI in their work and the benefits they get from using the AI.
This paper also gives us an insight into the concerns of the software engineers and managers regarding the use of AI for their work.

**Connection with other papers:**
Agrees with other papers regarding success factors that influence agile software development project success (Nguyen), success factors as critical that shape agile projects' success (Nguyen), excellence practices in Scrum (Pashchenko, 2024), reliable estimates

and Software Development, Jordanian Enterprises (2018), and Crowdsourcing in Software Development (Bibi et al., 2020).

**Interview Question Idea**

- Do you agree with the paper that says practitioners use GenAI as their assistant?
- Do you use AI for confidential projects as well? Where do you draw the line?
- Do you rely on the use of AI for making an important decision about the project development, delivery and execution?
- Can you share an incident where GenAI truly saved you from making a huge blunder on a project?

**Title: Paper 2**
Success Factors that Influence Agile Software Development Project Success

**Author:**
Dan Schilling Nguyen, Ph.D., Mt Washington College National Online Program, Alpharetta, Georgia, USA (single author).

**Year:** 2016

**Published in:** *American Scientific Research Journal for Engineering, Technology, and Sciences (ASRJETS)*, Volume 17, No. 1, pp. 172–222.

**Type of Study:**
Qualitative and phenomenological study

**Who They Studied?**
They studied the lived experiences of 10 agile software development team project managers and leaders from global companies in the United States.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that for the agile software projects to succeed, there need to be few of the things going in the right direction. According to the insights given by 10 agile managers, during the software development process, customers prefer to stay engaged in the whole process. This basically helps for the successful completion of the project due to the team's scrum-style process. Moreover, an effective product owner maximises the business value, sets priorities, engages stakeholders and follows good agile engineering practices for their software to perform properly.

**Engineer vs Manager:**
The technical side of the paper is described from the managers' point of view because only they were interviewed. As both the technical and managerial side both are equally important, they are interlinked.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper shows the gap in engineers' opinions, which will be filled once we interview them but for now only managers' views regarding success of agile projects were noted.

**Connection with other papers**
Connections to other papers such as Nguyen's companion paper (2016), the GenAI paper (2025), and the Scrum paper (Pashchenko, 2024)

**Quote or number worth citing**
“9/10 (90%) participants believe good agile engineering practices are key to the project's success. The paper also cites 2012 data of 72% success for agile vs 64% for traditional methods.

**Interview Question Idea**

- What is the most important factor for the project development, the technical aspects or the managerial aspects?

**Title: Paper 3**

Success Factors as Critical That Shape Agile Software Development Project Success

**Author:** Dan Schilling Nguyen

**Year:** 2016

**Where:** *International Journal of Sciences: Basic and Applied Research (IJSBAR)*, Vol. 25, No. 3, pp. 20–69.

**Type of study:** Interviews.

A qualitative, phenomenological study: open-ended questions answered by email, then coded into themes.

**Who they studied:** The paper studied 10 agile software development managers or leaders in the United States (5 in IT, 2 in manufacturing and 3 in defence). None of the engineers were interviewed or studied.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that the project will only succeed if the team communicates well with every layer of the hierarchy of the company and if engineering practices are closely implemented and monitored, the product owner maximises the product value and also if the sponsors fund the project.

**Engineer vs Manager:**
The technical side of the paper is described from the managers' point of view because only they were interviewed. As both the technical and managerial side both are equally important, they are interlinked.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper shows the gap in engineers' opinions, which will be filled once we interview them, but for now only managers' views regarding the success of agile projects were noted.

**Connection with other papers**
Connections to other papers such as Nguyen's companion paper (2016), the GenAI paper (2025), and the Scrum paper (Pashchenko, 2024).

**Quote or number worth citing**
“9/10 (90%) participants believe that automation helps for continuous integration of agile development principles, and design patterns help to reduce technical debt as well. The same majority pointed out that collaboration and communication skills are core success factors of a project.

**Interview question idea:** “Is continuous integration of development principles more significant than the communication skills of the team itself?”

**Title: Paper 4**

Reliable Estimate and Software Development/Jordanian Environment

**Authors:** Mohammad Mahmoud Tarawneh and Sattam Rakan Allahawiah (Balqa Applied University / Karak University College)

**Year:** May 2018

**Where:** *International Journal of Computer Applications*, Vol. 179, No. 44, pp. 10–14.

**Type of study:** Survey (questionnaire) with follow-up interviews.

**Who they studied:** The paper studied software project managers in Jordan. Questionnaires were given to 120 managers at a software company, and 20 of the managers were interviewed.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that the managers in Jordan repeatedly made the same mistakes while developing a project without learning from them. Furthermore, they could not allocate proper time and budget for a project to succeed, due to which they would always rely on past experience without adapting to modern tools and technologies. Due to this issue, the project always exceeded the timeline and budget allocation

**Engineer vs Manager:**
The paper focuses entirely on the manager's inability to perform well from their side during the project development process.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper shows how managers can also often struggle with their work, such as the estimation of numbers and their core managerial tasks.

**Connection with other papers**
The GenAI paper (2025) and The Nguyen papers (2016)

**Quote or number worth citing**
The usability of the system is affected by 59.70% when a project manager fails to estimate its cost.
**Interview question idea:** what kind of tools and technologies do you use to estimate the cost and timeline for a project?
What do you keep in mind to deliver the project on time?

**Title: Paper 5**

Excellence Practices in the Scrum Paradigm in Software Development

**Author:** Denis Pashchenko (SlavaSoft, Spain)

**Year:** 2025 (online Sept 2024)

**Where:** *Journal of Data Science and Intelligent Systems*, Vol. 3, No. 2, pp. 79–86

**Type of study:** Review

**Who they studied:** The paper is based on the author's industry experience and research from 2020 to 2023 across Russian, European and international IT companies. So, there are no participants.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that scrum practices work well when the goals are SMART and easily measurable. It also goes well when all the team roles are combined with AI tools to save time from doing repetitive tasks. Apart from this remote work, and more digitalisation makes scrum rely more on communication and documentation.

**Engineer vs Manager:**
The paper focuses on both roles but from a manager's point of view.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper shows how work is divided among managers and engineers in an scrum team.

**Connection with other papers**
The paper is closest to the GenAI paper (2025) and agrees with the Nguyen papers (2016).
It also connects somewhat with the Jordanian estimation paper (2018) for cost allocation and planning required for a project to develop. However, the paper is more about the author’s personal opinion itself.

**Quote or number worth citing**
About 20% of the team had started using AI tools, 43% planned to use it and 23% of experts use it regularly.

**Interview question idea:** N/A

**Title: Paper 6**

Crowdsourcing in Software Development: Empirical Support for Configuring Contests

**Author:** Stamatia Bibi, Ioannis Zozas, Apostolos Ampatzoglou, Panagiotis G. Sarigiannidis, George Kalampokis and Ioannis Stamelos (universities in Greece)

**Year:** 2020

**Where:** *IEEE Access*, Vol. 8, article starting at p. 58094.

**Type of study:** case study

**Who they studied:** The paper studied coding two contests, and participants were outsourced freelance developers who competed to win each of the given tasks.

**Main Finding**
The study found out that crowdsourcing seems to be a better way to get software development tasks done, even though successful completion depends a lot on task type. However, AI contests seem to attract more participants, but QA contests finish the fastest. One concern that the paper showed is that development contests have very low prizes for the amount of work done; due to this, managers should carefully analyse their goals and pick the task type.

**Engineer vs Manager:**
In the paper, both the roles are split into two halves. Managers organise the programme and decide what to crowdsource, why, when and how. On the other hand, engineers solve the problem.

**Useful for us because:**
This paper shows how managers' work affects the results with real numbers.

**Connection with other papers**
The paper agrees with the Jordanian estimation paper (2018) and connects to the Nguyen papers (2016). However, it connects loosely to the GenAI paper.

**Quote or number worth citing**
Design example: 60% of contests were successful across all indicators, like solution, time and quality.

**Interview question idea:**
- Have you ever outsourced or crowdsourced for a project? If yes, then how did it go?
- Does a project perform well when the development team is outsourced?